STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-3100
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **04/08/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT GENERAL APPEARANCE	CROSS REFERENCE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the general appearance for all Sheriff's Office employees.

II. Policy:

The personal appearance and grooming of employees are important for maintaining the dignity of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office. The standards set forth are not intended to suppress individual expression but are in keeping the professional standards. All personnel are required to be clean and presentable when reporting for duty. Division commanders have the authority to waive these standards to meet the individual needs for special assignments (e.g., Narcotics Unit). The Sheriff shall have the final authority in determining the appropriateness of any questionable appearance.

III. Definitions:

A. Conservative: Conservative is defined as traditional in style or manner, avoiding novelty or showiness.

IV. Procedures:

A. Hair: In the case of sworn personnel, hairstyles, mustaches, and sideburns shall not interfere with wearing uniform hats or other equipment (e.g., gas masks).

1. Males:

a) Male employees shall be clean-shaven when reporting for duty. Mustaches are permissible providing they do not extend downward past the lower lip or outward in an extreme fashion (e.g., handlebar mustache). The mustaches shall be neatly trimmed at all times. No beards, goatees or other facial hair is permissible unless the

employee is unable to shave for medical reasons while under a physician's care and with approval from the Sheriff.

(1) Should an employee meet this medical exemption, he shall maintain a well-kempt, neatly trimmed beard ¼" or shorter in length at all times while in a duty assignment normally required to be clean shaven.

b) Sideburns shall be neatly trimmed and are not to exceed below the lowest portion of the ear. Sideburns may not be "flared" at the bottom or fashioned in an extreme manner.

c) Male employees shall wear their hair according to the following guidelines:

(1) Hairstyles shall not be of an extreme nature nor have symbols shaved into the hair.

(2) Conservative in appearance and of a natural color (i.e., blond, brown, etc.).

(3) Hair shall be clean and neatly trimmed.

(4) Hair shall not exceed past mid forehead in the front, nor past the top of the shirt collar in the back.

(5) Hair shall not cover the top of the ears on the sides.

2. Females:

a) Hairstyles shall not be of an extreme nature (e.g., spiked) nor have symbols shaved into the hair.

b) Conservative in appearance and of a natural color (i.e., blond, brown, etc.).

c) Hair shall be clean and neatly trimmed.

d) While on duty in uniform, female deputies who choose to wear their hair longer than shoulder length shall have their hair gathered into a ponytail, bun, or similar fashion. Only those items necessary to hold the hair in place may be worn. These items shall not be decorative in nature and shall not be shiny or extreme in color. Bows and ribbons shall not be worn.

B. **Jewelry:** Personnel shall abide by the following guidelines regarding jewelry and other adornments while on duty:

1. **Males:**

a) No visible body piercings.
b) No earrings shall be worn.
c) Necklaces, if worn, shall be worn under the shirt.
d) A total of no more than three rings shall be worn on the hands.

2. **Females:**

a) No visible body piercings, other than pierced ears.
b) Female deputies shall wear no more than two earrings per ear.
c) Female deputies shall not wear any earring that dangles or hangs below the earlobe (e.g., hoops).
d) Necklaces, if worn, shall be worn under the uniform shirt.
e) Female deputies shall wear a total of no more than three rings on the hands.

C. **Fingernails:**

1. Fingernails are to be neat and trimmed and shall not interfere with the efficient operation of equipment.

a) Males: Fingernail polish, if worn, shall be clear.

b) Females: Fingernail polish, if worn, shall be conservative and professional in appearance.

D. **Cosmetics:** Cosmetics, if worn, shall be subdued, and blended to match the natural skin color of the individual except in the case of eye makeup, which shall be conservative in color.

E. **Tattoos:** Employees, while on duty or working an approved off-duty position representing the Sheriff's Office, shall be permitted to display tattoos and/or body ink under the following conditions:

1. Employees shall be permitted to display tattoos and/or body ink which is not reasonably associated with or related to content that is racist, sexist, gang affiliated, extremist or supremacist ideology, criminal in nature or that which may bring discredit to the Sheriff's Office.

2. When displaying tattoos and/or body ink or obtaining new tattoos and/or body ink in which the employee intends to display, each employee shall consider G-1000 Sheriff's Office Mission Statement, G-1100 Code of Ethics,

and G-1200 Standards of Conduct to ensure they are an appropriate representation of the Sheriff's Office.

3. Employees shall not have tattoos and/or body ink that are visible above the shoulders, or on the hands. An exception will be made for a single tattoo around a finger that is meant to replace a wedding ring/band.

4. Employees must be able to outfit a Class A uniform without visible tattoos and/or body ink.

5. Any tattoo and/or body ink that is deemed offensive, immoral, or presents an unprofessional appearance shall be covered.

6. The Sheriff or his designee shall make all final determinations on whether an employee's tattoos and/or body ink comply with this policy.

F. **Ornamental Body Modifications:** Employees, while working on duty or an approved off-duty position representing the Sheriff's Office, shall not display any visible ornamental body modifications including but not limited to piercings (excluding pierced ears), subdermal implants, or transdermal implants.

1. Uniformed employees shall cover any visible ornamental body modifications by using flesh-colored bandages or sleeves. With permission of the Sheriff, uniformed employees may cover ornamental body modifications by wearing an approved uniform which may include wearing a long-sleeved uniform year-round.

2. Non-uniformed employees shall cover any visible ornamental body modifications by wearing approved attire.

3. Employees shall not have ornamental body modifications above the collar, on the face, on the hands, on the tongue, or on the teeth.